

LIGHTHOUSE
enlightening tender minds

**CHILDREN'S
MAGAZINE**
10-14 YEARS

BACK To SCHOOL

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FORWARD WITH PURPOSE

FROM
THE
EDITOR

As the gates of our schools open and the corridors buzz with life once again, we find ourselves back in classrooms—joking with our benchmates, flipping through fresh notebooks, and easing into familiar routines. However, it's important to remember that we're not merely returning to a building—we're stepping back into a journey of growth, purpose, and self-discovery.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) beautifully emphasized the pursuit of knowledge as a sacred obligation "Whoever takes a path in search of knowledge, Allah will make easy for him a path to Paradise." (Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 2699)

And before we label these classrooms as boring or dry, let me remind you from personal experience—these very rooms will hold the memories we'll cherish for a lifetime. Academic education is far more than textbooks and examinations. It is a centuries-old effort to build moral character, foster responsibility toward the environment, learn from our historical forebears, and fulfill our divine duty to seek knowledge.

In this edition of Lighthouse, we aim to revisit those nostalgic moments of school life, while also highlighting the deeper value of academic learning. In the Divine Illumination section, we reflect on the natural world and the powerful signs it offers—like a motherly teacher guiding us with wisdom and care. We also honor the legacy of legendary figures like Fatima al-Fihriya, whose contributions continue to shape the modern educational system.

This issue reminds us that learning isn't confined to classrooms. It flourishes in our daily lives—in our skills, values, ideas, and actions. As you begin a new term, make the most of this opportunity: learn with sincerity, refine your abilities, serve with integrity, and dream with vision.

Together, let's build a Lighthouse that shines brightly—a beacon of hope for all navigating the vast oceans of uncertainty. "Let's return not just with bags and books, but with hearts ready to grow."



Suhaib Ahmed Khan

EDITOR-IN-CHIEF,
LIGHTHOUSE CHILDREN'S MAGAZINE

01

Divine ILLUMINATION

WHOSE MOON IS IT, ANYWAY?



Dr. Talha Fayazuddin
MD, PHYSIOLOGY (OMC)



As Arqam was gazing at the night sky, the bright full moon shone back at him. In an inquisitive tone, he asked his father sitting beside him, “Baba, who created the moon? His father replied, “Allah, our Creator, has created the moon, sun, stars, and the entire universe.”

Curious Arqam immediately followed up with another question, “Baba, for whom exactly did Allah create the moon and other things in the universe?”

Knowing how deep and meaningful this question was, his father chose not to give a short or general answer. Instead, he spoke thoughtfully.

“My son, there are two extremes among people. One extreme believes that the sun, moon, stars, and other creations are so superior that we shouldn’t talk about them in scientific terms or even consider researching them.

They exaggerate the status of these creations so much that they begin to worship them. This was the mindset of the people in the society where Prophet Ibrahim (peace be upon him) was born around 4,500 years ago. Sadly, the same thinking still exists today, even with all our modern scientific knowledge. It was this attitude that led to the imprisonment of Galileo Galilei for his ideas about the universe—and even the burning alive of Giordano Bruno, along with many other scientists of their time.”

After a short pause, he continued, “On the other side, there’s another extreme—people who completely ignore the Creator of this universe and consider themselves to be the hereditary ‘owners’ of this Earth. They follow their desires, doing whatever they wish. They waste resources, exploit nature recklessly, and often hoard what was meant for everyone, stopping others from benefitting from it.”

With a deep sigh, Arqam's father added some real-world facts:

"From 2002 to 2023, the world lost 76.3 million hectares of humid primary forest—16% of the total tree cover loss. Around 703 million people, or 1 in 11 globally, don't have access to basic drinking water. 44% of surface water is too polluted for use, and 31% of groundwater is contaminated with harmful substances. The World Health Organization (WHO) estimates that 7 million people die every year due to air pollution-related illnesses. All of this is the result of arrogance and selfishness—assuming ownership and ignoring the consequences of exploiting the environment. The destruction of land and sea continues across the globe."

He then quoted a verse from the Qur'an:

"Corruption has appeared on land and sea because of what the hands of people have earned."
(Qur'an – Surah Ar-Rum, 30:41)

Arqam, wide-eyed, interrupted, "Baba, then who are the right people?"

"That is THE question, my son!" his father exclaimed, and continued, "If laws were made only by those who dare not think, science would never have advanced—and we would still be in the dark ages. On the other hand, if laws were made by those who ignore the Creator and follow only their own desires, the entire ecosystem would be ruined. So, no human can create perfect laws. Only the Creator of the universe has the right to decide how we should live and interact with nature."

He then recited a beautiful verse from the Qur'an

"It is Allah Who created the heavens and the earth and sends down rain from the sky, causing fruits to grow as provision for you. He has subjected the ships for your service, sailing through the sea by His command, and has subjected the rivers for you. He has also subjected for you the sun and the moon, both constantly orbiting, and has subjected the day and night for you."
(Qur'an – Surah Ibrahim, 14:32–33)

Then, he explained, "These verses—and many more—give us the most balanced way of understanding our relationship with the environment and with Allah, the Creator of the universe. Allah says that He created the skies and the rain, the earth and its crops, for you. He made the laws of the universe so that ships could sail and airplanes could fly for your benefit. He has subjected the sun and the moon, and even time itself—day and night—for you."



He paused, letting Arqam absorb the message.

"This divine message gives us two powerful insights:

1. Allah is the Creator and Owner of the universe.
2. Everything in this universe is created for human beings, but given to them as a trust (Amanah)."

"When we understand this, our attitude toward the universe completely changes. We no longer worship nature or fear it blindly. Nor do we act as arrogant owners. Instead, we act as trustees—responsible for caring for and using these blessings wisely. We benefit from rivers but ensure we don't pollute them. We enjoy nature without overusing it."

As Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him) said:

'Do not be wasteful, even if you are on the banks of a flowing river.'
(Sahih, Musnad Ahmad)

Arqam thought for a moment and then said:

"Baba, that means the moon—and everything else in the universe—is for us, but as a trust. We are supposed to benefit from them equally and take care of them, not become fearful slaves or arrogant owners. Right?"

"Yes, beta, you've understood the most fundamental concept correctly and completely," his father replied with a warm smile.

Arqam concluded thoughtfully:

"Baba, when I go back to school after vacation, I'll study physics, biology, and geography with this mindset. I had never thought about this beautiful universe in such a meaningful way before."

"That's wonderful, beta," replied Arqam's father with a wide smile.

"When we study the world through the lens of Imaan, every subject takes us closer to the Almighty."

LEGENDARY
PERSONALITIES

—•——•—

FATIMA AL-FIHRI

—•——•—

THE FOUNDER OF
THE WORLD'S FIRST
UNIVERSITY

NABILA TEHREEM

CLASS 9TH,
ZIKRA HIGH SCHOOL

06

Fatima al-Fihri's university, Al-Qarawiyyin, became a center for learning where students studied math, science, languages, medicine, law, the Qur'an, and much more. People from all over the world came to study there, and some of the ideas and knowledge taught at Al-Qarawiyyin even influenced universities in Europe later on!

LEGENDARY PERSONALITIES

What Makes Her Story Special?

A Pioneer of Education:

Fatima al-Fihri believed that everyone—rich or poor, men or women—should have the chance to learn. This idea was very new at that time!

A Role Model for Girls:

She showed that women can lead, build, and contribute to society in big ways. She is proof that girls can do anything with faith, vision, and effort.

A Champion of Knowledge and Faith:

Her university combined both religious and worldly knowledge. Students learned how to become good citizens and good Muslims.

A Legacy That Lives On:

Even today, over 1,000 years later, the University of Al-Qarawiyyin is still teaching students! Her dream lives on through every student who walks through its doors.

Fatima al-Fihri didn't just build a building—she built a future for generations of learners. She reminds us that education is not just about books and exams, but about making the world a better place.

Fatima al-Fihri's life is a remarkable example of how knowledge, faith, and generosity can create a lasting legacy. Her contribution to education through the establishment of Al-Qarawiyyin inspires us to pursue learning with purpose and to serve humanity with sincerity. She is a true role model whose story reminds us that great change often begins with a single, dedicated individual.



STORY
TIME

The Magic of *MISTAKES*



SYEDA AFIYA HALEEMA

CLASS 10TH,
ZIKRA HIGH SCHOOL

09

STORY TIME

In Crestwood Middle School, Ava was known as the “perfect student.” She always aced her tests, submitted flawless homework, and never made mistakes. Her classmates admired her, but secretly, Ava lived in fear of messing up. One day, the school announced a science fair. Determined to win, Ava decided to build a complex robot. She spent weeks planning every detail, but as she assembled the robot, nothing worked as expected.

The gears jammed, wires tangled, and the robot wouldn't even move. Frustrated, Ava considered giving up. At that moment, her classmate Maya walked by and noticed her struggle. Known for her curiosity and hands-on approach, Maya often made mistakes but never seemed bothered by them.

She offered to help, and although hesitant, Ava agreed. Maya suggested they start from scratch, but this time, experiment with different parts without worrying about perfection. They tried various combinations, laughed when things failed, and celebrated small successes.

Slowly, the robot took shape. On the day of the fair, Ava's robot wasn't the most polished, but it moved, spun, and even danced a little. Although they didn't win first place, the judges praised their creativity and perseverance. Ava realized that making mistakes wasn't a sign of failure but a part of learning.

From that day forward, Ava embraced challenges without fear. She discovered that mistakes were not obstacles but stepping stones to success.

Moral: Perfection is not the goal—growth is. Embracing mistakes helps you learn and discover new possibilities.





Submit your ART & WRITEUPS to
LIGHTHOUSECHILDRENSMAGAZINE
@GMAIL.COM



RIDDLES:

I'm something you waste and wish you had more of. **WHAT AM I?**

Ans: Time

I pull you from your book to your phone in seconds.

WHAT AM I?

Ans: Distraction

I may seem boring, but I'm the key to mastery.

WHAT AM I?

Ans: Consistency

I can ruin success by making you careless. I sound like strength but weaken your results.

WHAT AM I?

Ans: Over confidence

I am what makes a hero respected, even if they fail. I live in actions more than words.

WHAT AM I?

Ans: Good character

I keep your thumb moving while your mind feels worse.

WHAT AM I?

Ans: Doomscrolling

I help you accept mistakes and grow from them.

WHAT AM I?

Ans: Humility

WORD SEARCH

Find the following words in the puzzle. Words are hidden in



G	R	A	T	I	T	U	D	E	W	R	E	A	L	X	O	F	C
M	G	C	W	Z	K	K	E	H	W	E	X	O	P	Q	P	A	T
L	M	A	S	T	E	R	Y	F	R	F	L	D	D	V	A	W	B
A	S	P	I	R	A	T	I	O	N	L	X	H	T	N	T	I	V
R	M	Z	A	O	B	W	X	W	W	E	B	T	M	R	I	S	N
E	F	F	O	R	T	E	H	I	K	C	L	R	E	W	E	D	T
E	O	N	K	V	H	E	F	S	C	T	H	O	V	Y	N	O	M
H	C	R	E	S	E	A	R	C	H	I	C	C	M	C	C	M	T
M	U	N	X	X	H	Y	F	T	R	O	I	G	G	D	E	U	F
W	S	F	E	I	L	Y	W	X	Q	N	I	P	M	P	X	V	D
O	Z	Z	R	S	S	P	R	O	G	R	E	S	S	X	D	S	W
V	Z	W	Z	G	B	S	A	C	R	I	F	I	C	E	B	K	V

ASPIRATION
REFLECTION
SACRIFICE
GRATITUDE
PROGRESS
PATIENCE
RESEARCH
MASTERY
WISDOM
EFFORT
FOCUS

12

My Second Home

SAFOORA FATIMA
CLASS 9TH
ZIKRA HIGH SCHOOL

When I reflect on my school days, a flood of memories rushes in—some funny, some emotional, but all unforgettable. School wasn't just about books and exams; it was also about personal growth, discovering new ideas, and developing a positive character and creative mind.

A school is like a buffet of knowledge. It's a place where we create moments that stay with us forever and bring joy whenever we remember them.

Even the ordinary days held a bit of magic—like walking into the classroom and spotting your best friend already seated, or getting caught whispering during class and trying not to laugh. All these tiny moments add up to something truly memorable. I truly enjoy my school experience.

School is one of my favorite places to be. It's not just a place for studying—it's where I explore new things beyond academics, meet friends, and create unforgettable memories with them. What I cherish most are the moments spent with my friends.

There's also a humorous side to school, as learning often goes hand-in-hand with laughter. This building isn't just made of bricks and walls—it's where every student begins their journey toward a stronger, brighter future.

A school is like a giant lunchbox filled with delicious learning experiences, with teachers as the chefs who prepare lessons for us each day. Some lessons are as sweet as sugar; others may feel like bitter gourd. Yet all of them nourish our minds, making them more powerful and resilient.

The few years I spent in school were the best of my life. The challenges I faced, the exams I took, the struggle for good grades, the fun with friends, that one exceptional teacher, the strict principal, the picnics, the stress of completing assignments, and the fight to wake up early—all of these are part of my cherished memories.

School is the best fully balanced meal for the brain—served fresh every day. My school feels like my second home, a place I deeply enjoy and am grateful for. The moments may be temporary, but the memories are everlasting.

POWER OF THE POMODORO



WHY IT WORKS:

Keeps your brain fresh
Helps avoid distractions
Makes boring tasks easier
Teaches time management like a pro!
Makes boring tasks

Ever felt that your mind starts to wander when you study for too long? Don't worry—there's a super cool method to help you stay focused without getting bored. It's called the Pomodoro Technique (Po-mo-DO-ro)!



POMODORO STEPS:

- 1 Pick a task (homework, reading, project—anything!).
- 2 Set a timer for 25 minutes.
- 3 Focus only on that task until the timer rings!
- 4 Take a 5-minute break—stretch, drink water, or doodle.
- 5 After 4 rounds, take a longer break (15–30 minutes).

DID YOU KNOW?

- 1 The pencil was invented more than 400 years ago—but still doesn't go out of style!
- 2 In ancient times, libraries were considered more important than palaces!
- 3 Studies show that reviewing what you learned within 24 hours helps you remember better.
- 4 Al-Khwarizmi's name is where the word "algorithm" comes from—it's the foundation of modern computing.
- 5 Recycling just one notebook saves enough energy to power a computer for 30 minutes!



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MAY WE HELP YOU

Troubles and challenges are a part of life, but every problem has a solution. Sometimes, all we need is a little guidance. Lighthouse is here to help. Reach out to us at lighthousechildrensmagazine@gmail.com

SPEAK YOUR MIND!

If you waited till you felt like writing, you'd never write at all. The desire to write grows with writing. Cherish and nourish your desire by sending us your write-ups (articles, poems, stories, etc) via lighthousechildrensmagazine@gmail.com

IDEAL CHILDREN'S ASSOCIATION

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